How SLANT measures thermospheric composition

SLANT: Solar Limb Absorption of Neutrals in the Thermosphere

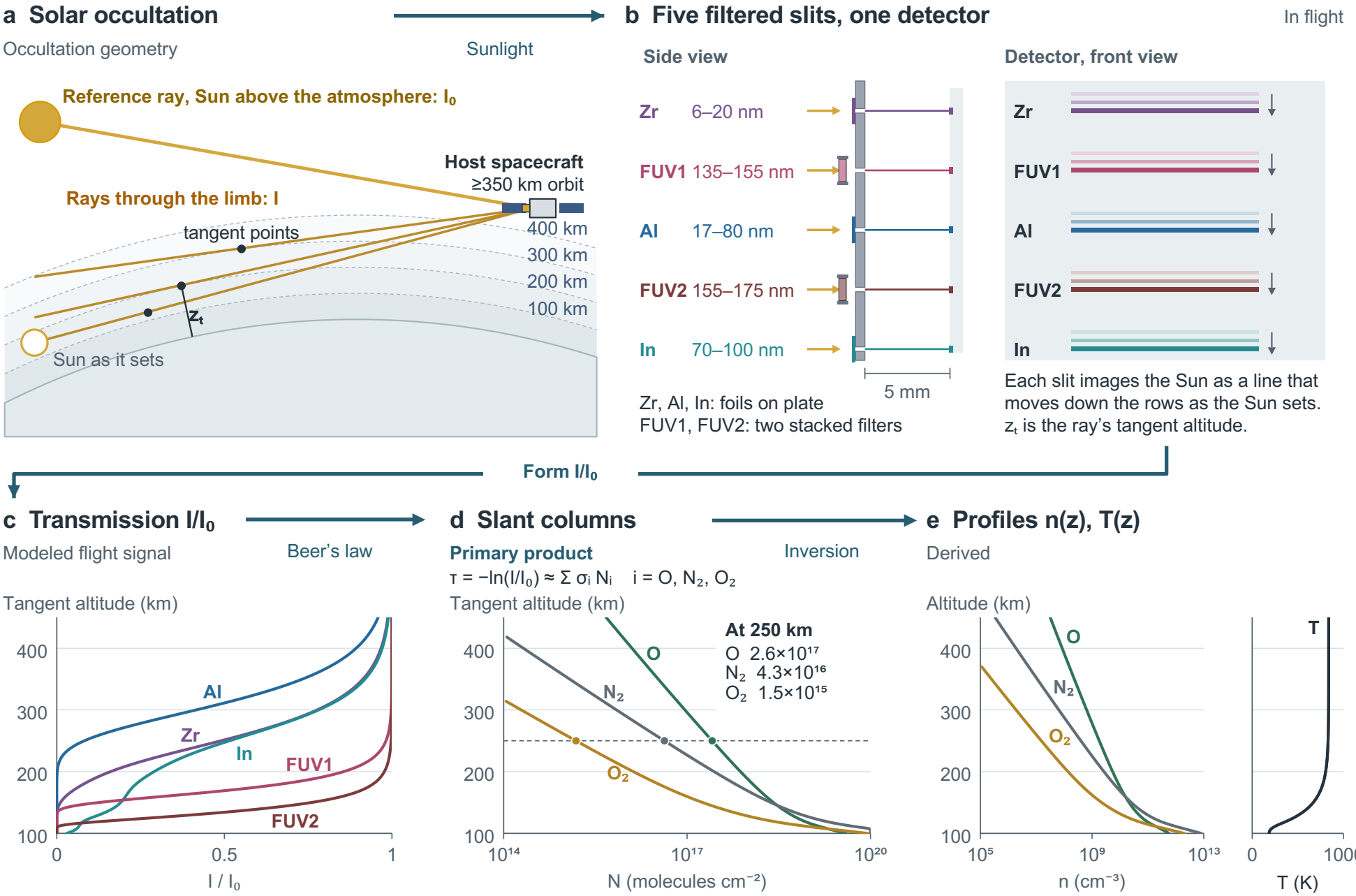


Figure 1. I/I_0 gives optical depth; Beer's law converts it to O, N_2 and O_2 slant columns, the primary product.
Inversion gives density and temperature. Curves in (c–e) model a quiet NRLMSIS 2.1 atmosphere; Zr and In use measured filter curves.